



# Never Miss Another Call

The Home Services Owner's Guide to AI Voice Agents

Your AI-powered front desk, 24/7/365.

[stellarvoiceagents.com](https://stellarvoiceagents.com) · June 2026

# The \$120,000 Problem

Every contractor knows the feeling: you check voicemail on Monday and find weekend calls from homeowners who already booked someone else.

The average home services business misses around 27% of inbound calls and loses \$45,000 to \$120,000 a year to calls nobody answered. Miss just five calls a week at a \$500 ticket and that is \$130,000 walking out the door.

**27%** of inbound calls go unanswered

**\$120K** a year lost to missed calls

**\$350+** value of one missed HVAC call

**The problem is not your marketing or your pricing. The problem is that nobody picks up the phone.**

Sources: CallRail and AgentZap 2026, CallBird AI 2026, ServiceTitan benchmark data.



# Are You the First to Answer?

78% of customers book with the first company that responds. Yet the average home services business takes 3.7 hours to call a lead back. Respond within 60 seconds and conversions rise by 391%.

A text reply under a minute books 73% of the time; after 30 minutes it is 4%. When a homeowner's AC dies at 2pm in July, they are calling the first three companies they find. The one that answers books the job.

**An AI voice agent answers in under one second, every time. No hold music. No please leave a message.**

Sources: Lead Connect 2026, ServiceTitan 2025, Velocify, Hatch 2025, MIT and InsideSales.

## Response Time vs. Booking Probability

The faster you respond, the more jobs you win.



Responding within the first few minutes dramatically increases your chance of winning the job.

Chance of Booking



### Key Takeaway



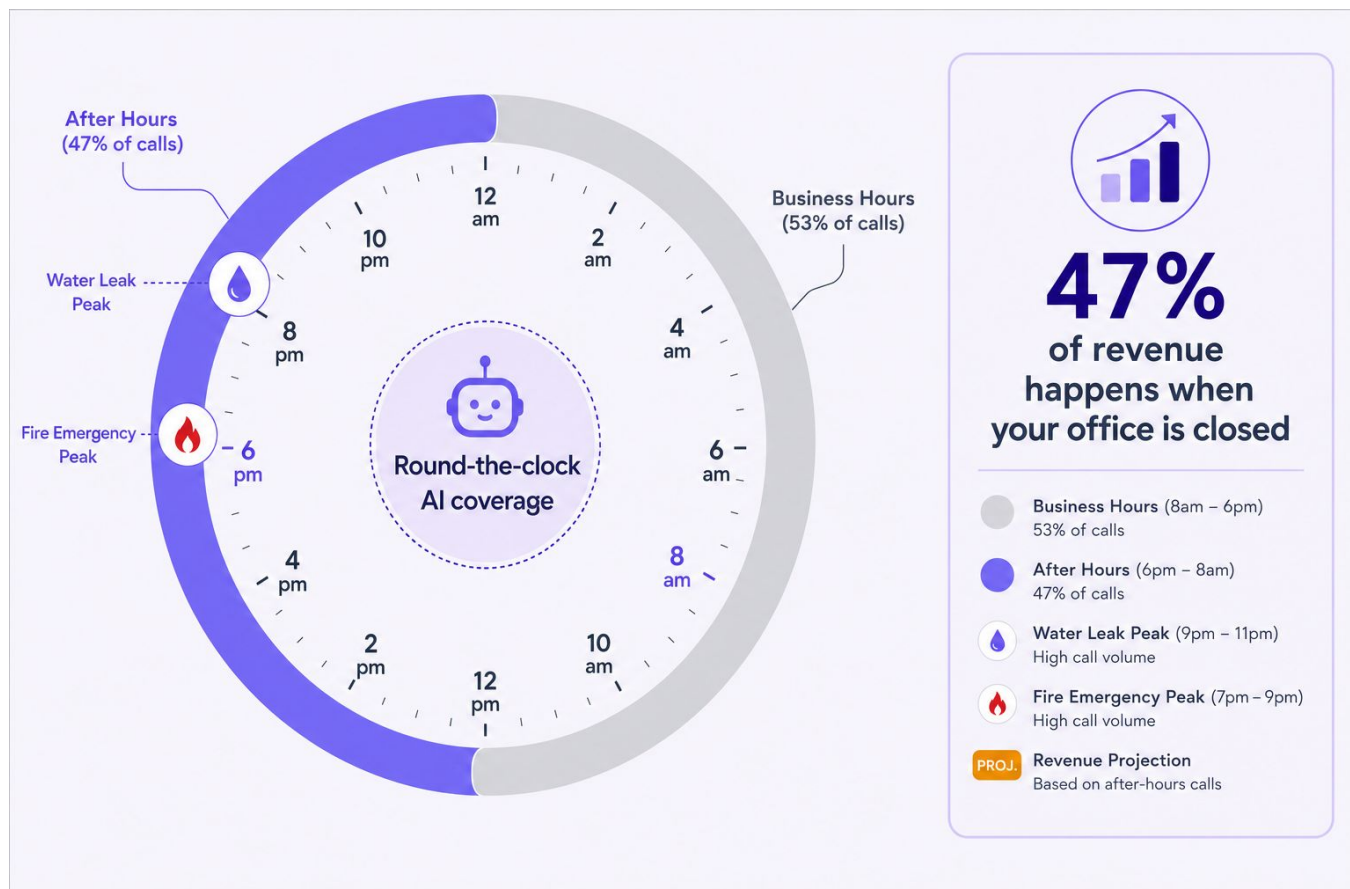
Respond within the first 5 minutes to maximize your chances of booking the job.

# Where the Real Money Hides

Almost half of all home services calls, 47%, come outside business hours. For plumbing it is 62%. These are not casual enquiries. A homeowner calling at 9pm about a burst pipe has maximum urgency and minimum patience, and will call the next company in 30 seconds if you do not answer.

Then come the surges. HVAC calls jump more than 4x in a heat wave. Plumbing searches spike 191% in summer and 609% for frozen pipes in January. A traditional answering service takes a message. An AI voice agent qualifies the caller, books the emergency or the next-day slot, and texts your team. That is the difference between a \$0 voicemail and a \$500 job.

Sources: CallRail and AgentZap 2026, Ainora 2026, WebFX seasonal search data.



# What an AI Voice Agent Does

Strip away the hype. When a customer calls, the AI answers in under a second and greets them by your company name in a natural voice; most callers cannot tell it is AI. It finds out the service needed, the location, and the urgency, then books the job: emergency dispatch or the next available slot.

1. Answers in under one second, no hold music, no press one for service.
2. Identifies the service and triages urgency in one or two questions.
3. Books the emergency dispatch or the next open appointment.
4. Confirms the caller's number and texts the details to the customer and your team.

Total call time is usually 90 seconds to two minutes. Works 24/7/365 and handles unlimited calls at once.



# How It Fits Your Trade

AI is not one-size-fits-all. Each trade has its own call patterns, urgency, and job values. Here is where an AI voice agent earns its keep across the trades you run.

Notice the spread. A solar consultation lost is twenty thousand dollars gone; a plumbing call lost is a few hundred, but plumbing takes the most after-hours calls of any trade.

HVAC lives and dies by the seasonal surge, when volume can jump more than four times in a heat wave. The agent is tuned to each: it knows a sparking outlet is an emergency and a quote request is not, and it gives a high-value solar enquiry the real qualification it deserves.

Sources: ServiceTitan, AgentZap, and Ainora trade benchmark data, 2026.

| Trade        | Avg Job Value  | Emergency Rate | Where AI Helps Most                        |
|--------------|----------------|----------------|--------------------------------------------|
| HVAC         | \$400 to \$14K | High in peak   | Triages surges and books repairs instantly |
| Plumbing     | \$182 to \$500 | High           | Captures the most after-hours calls        |
| Electrical   | \$150 to \$4K  | Moderate       | Safety-critical triage and dispatch        |
| Solar        | \$18K to \$40K | Low            | Qualifies high-value consultations         |
| Roofing      | \$300 to \$25K | Storm spikes   | Handles 10x post-storm call floods         |
| Construction | \$5K to \$100K | Low            | Scopes budget and timeline upfront         |
| Landscaping  | \$200 to \$55K | Low            | Manages seasonal surge and rebookings      |

# The Math That Makes It a No-Brainer

The formula is simple: your monthly calls, times the 27% you miss, times the share an AI recovers (around 65%), times your average job value. The AI does not cost money; missed calls cost money. Here is the model on three trades, at a typical AI voice cost of \$500 to \$1,500 a month.

Run your own numbers and the result barely moves. The AI does not need to be perfect; it just needs to answer the calls you are already paying to generate. Even the most conservative trade in the table pays the system back many times over, and the busier your phone, the bigger the gap it closes. This is the rare investment that costs less the more work it does.

*How many calls do you take in a month, and what is one booked job worth to you? Multiply it out. The AI pays for itself on the first one or two recovered jobs.*

Conservative inputs based on industry benchmarks. Individual results vary. No outcome is guaranteed.

| Trade    | Calls / mo | Recovered / mo | Per Year  | ROI    |
|----------|------------|----------------|-----------|--------|
| HVAC     | 300        | \$31,500       | \$378,000 | 21-63x |
| Plumbing | 200        | \$14,000       | \$168,000 | 9-28x  |
| Solar    | 80         | \$35,000       | \$420,000 | 23-70x |



# What Early Adopters Are Seeing

This is not theoretical. One contractor's booking rate jumped from 55% to 90% after moving from an answering service to AI. Another booked 5 calls with live answering across two-thirds of a month, then 43 calls with AI in the final third. SVA's own client, EasyStart Homes, has held a 17 to 25% booking rate for more than six months with zero human caller time, and that system does not even have speed-to-lead yet.

**55% to 90%** booking rate after switching to AI

**17-25%** EasyStart rate, 6+ months live

**< 3 mo** typical payback period

**After testing the voice AI himself, EasyStart's Denes Aldott said:  
'That's just so unreal, well done!'**

Sources: Avoca AI and Numa AI case data, Nextiva ROI analysis, SVA internal data. Projections are modelled.





# The Questions That Book More Jobs

The AI does not run a ten-question survey. It captures only what it needs to book the right technician with the right context, one question at a time, then gets out of the way. Deep discovery is the expert's job on the booked call.

There is a discipline behind the short list. The Vapi Bible calls it minimum viable qualification: ask one thing at a time, capture only what the booking needs, and confirm rather than interrogate. A homeowner with a burst pipe does not want a survey; they want to know someone is coming. So the agent triages, books, and reassures, and leaves the diagnosis to your technician at the door.

Minimum viable qualification: a booked job in under two minutes, not a completed intake form.

| The AI Asks                    | So It Can                         |
|--------------------------------|-----------------------------------|
| What can we help you with?     | Identify the service type         |
| What is your address or area?  | Confirm you cover it              |
| Is this urgent or can it wait? | Triage emergency versus scheduled |
| Anything the tech should know? | Capture one open note, verbatim   |
| When works best for you?       | Book the appointment              |
| Is this the best number?       | Confirm contact without dictation |

# It Plugs Into What You Already Use

No rip and replace. The AI works alongside your current stack, using your existing phone number through call forwarding. Choose overflow (office rings first, AI picks up if no answer), full coverage, or after-hours only.

Nothing about your current setup has to change. Calls forward from the number you already advertise, bookings land in the schedule your dispatchers already watch, and every lead, with its recording and transcript, flows into the CRM your team already opens each morning. Start with after-hours only, add daytime overflow, and move to full coverage when you are ready. The agent fits your business; your business does not bend to it.

Dispatchers see booked jobs appear in real time, with the call recording and transcript logged.

| Connects With                       | What Happens                               |
|-------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------|
| ServiceTitan, Housecall Pro, Jobber | Books jobs straight into your schedule     |
| GoHighLevel, Salesforce, HubSpot    | Creates leads with full qualification data |
| Your existing phone number          | Forwards calls, no number change           |
| SMS and email                       | Confirms with customer and team instantly  |
| n8n, Zapier, Make                   | Triggers follow-ups and record updates     |

# But What If...

## **My customers want to talk to a real person.**

They want their problem solved, and 78% book with whoever responds first. Faced with a person who answers in 3.7 hours or an AI that answers in one second, customers choose speed. Satisfaction actually rises into the 90 to 95% range, because calls never hit voicemail and hold times disappear.

## **AI cannot handle complex technical questions.**

It does not need to. Its job is to qualify and book, not diagnose. The technician handles the technical work on site. The AI captures only what is needed to send the right person.

## **What about emergencies?**

The AI is trained on the emergency signals for each trade, active leaks, gas smell, sparking, no heat in winter, and triages on defined rules every time. It dispatches or escalates to an on-call technician, and never misjudges urgency because it is busy.

## **I already have an answering service.**

Answering services take messages. They do not qualify, book, or integrate with your schedule, and they charge per call when volume surges. An AI voice agent qualifies, books, and confirms at a flat monthly rate no matter the volume.

# Your Next Customer Is Calling Right Now

## Book a free 15-minute strategy call:

- 1 We review your call volume, missed-call rate, and lead sources.
- 2 We model the ROI for your trade and your business size.
- 3 No contracts, no pressure, just the numbers.

**Every day you wait is another five to ten calls going to voicemail, and to your competitors.**

Want to hear it first? Ask us for a sample AI call handling a real scenario in your trade. Reply to the email that delivered this guide.



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